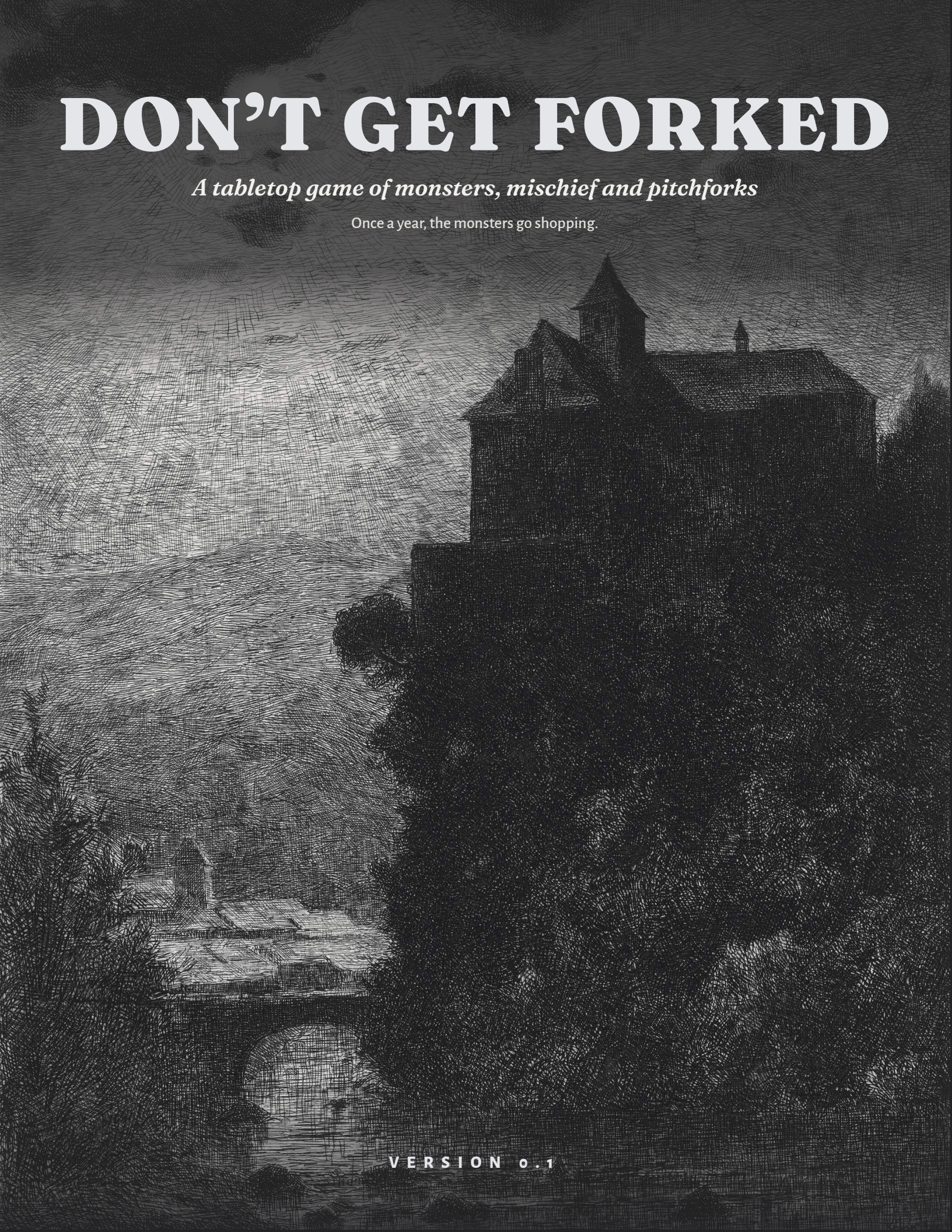


DON'T GET FORKED

A tabletop game of monsters, mischief and pitchforks

Once a year, the monsters go shopping.



VERSION 0.1

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GAME DESIGN & WRITING

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STAND-IN ILLUSTRATIONS

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PART ONE

Playing the Game

*The Entities, the dice, the raid, Suspicion, the chase and how
the year went: everything the players need at the table.*





CHAPTER 1

The Game

YOU PLAY CLASSIC MONSTERS WHO SHARE A CASTLE IN the woods. Once a year, on Lantern Night, the town's festival, when everyone is in costume, you go down to steal what the castle needs. Get the shopping list home before dawn — and if the job goes wrong, outrun the mob before it corners you with pitchforks.

What a Raid Is

Each **raid** is on a new town and stands alone: nothing from earlier raids carries over, unless your group uses the optional campaign rules (Chapter 7). A raid runs **1–2 hours**, so an evening often fits two. *In the story, every raid is the year's first stock-up.*

The Storyteller chooses how hard the town is: **Easy**, **Standard or Hard** (Chapter 8). The choice sets the shopping list's size, the Suspicion Limit and a few other numbers. It isn't an obstacle's Difficulty, the number you roll against (Chapter 3).

Who Plays

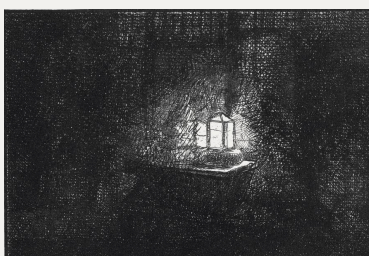
3–5 players each play one of the eight **Entities**. One more person is the **Storyteller**, who runs the town, its villagers and the mob. The tone is horror-comedy for about 12 and up: real stakes, dark jokes, nothing gory.

What You Need

- Each player: one each of d4, d6, d8, d10 and d12 (the trait dice, Chapter 2), plus a second d6 (the Mask) and a second d10 (the Monster).
- The Storyteller: a d20. When Chapter 8 calls for a d3, roll a d6, halve it and round up.
- An Entity Sheet for each player (copy the one at the back of the book), and something to track Suspicion (Chapter 5), Turns (Chapter 4) and the Lead (Chapter 6).
- A town to raid: a premade one (Chapter 9), or one the Storyteller draws on a map or rolls on the random tables (Chapter 8).

THE RAID AT A GLANCE

- The Storyteller rolls the **shopping list**: one or two essentials, the rest extras (Chapter 4).
- **Visit the town's locations** before dawn (12 Turns), getting past their obstacles and taking the loot (Chapter 4).
- **Choose on every roll**: hide behind your Mask, or let the Monster out (Chapter 3).
- **Watch Suspicion**: when it reaches the Limit, the whole town hunts you (Chapter 5).
- **Get out of town** with the goods — or run for it, and don't get forked (Chapter 6).





CHAPTER 2

The Entities

EIGHT ENTITIES SHARE THE CASTLE: DRACULA, Frankenstein's Creature, the Mummy, the Werewolf, the Invisible Man, a Ghost, a Witch, and Jekyll & Hyde. Each player picks one. No two players in a party play the same Entity.

Five Traits

Every Entity has five **traits**:

TRAIT	FOR
Brawn	Force, lifting, breaking, fighting
Nimble	Climbing, running, slipping free
Sly	Sneaking, hiding, stealing
Charm	Talking, bluffing, passing as human
Wits	Noticing, knowing, figuring things out

Each trait is rated as a die. **Every Entity has one each of d12, d10, d8, d6 and d4**, placed differently: what one Entity does with a d12, another fumbles with a d4. Jekyll & Hyde has two forms on one sheet, each with its own arrangement of the same five dice.

The Mask and the Monster

Every roll adds a second die to the trait die. You choose which: the **Mask d6**, passing as human, or the **Monster d10**, letting the monster out. The Monster is stronger, but it risks Suspicion (Chapter 3). Every Entity has the same pair.

What Every Entity Has

- **Its dice arrangement.**
- **A signature ability**, and a second ability chosen as its **Gift**.
- **A Weakness**: something the town can use against it.
- **A Tell**: how it gives itself away.

Three Picks

Each Entity is premade, with three picks. Every pick has a marked default, so a new player can skip the choices; to pick at random, roll a d6: 1–2 the first option, 3–4 the second, 5–6 the third (for the Castle Duty, roll on its table, rerolling one already taken).

- **Gift**: one of three versions of the Entity's second ability.
- **Perk**: one of three edges, always on and free; each bends one rule in one situation.
- **Castle Duty**: one of the castle's household jobs, shared by all the Entities, each with a small edge tied to the shopping list (hear it before you pick). No two Entities in a party take the same Duty.

Charges

Every Entity has **3 charges**. One charge pays for one use of an ability. Charges refill once a year, at the castle; any you don't spend on a raid are lost, so spend them.

ABILITIES NEVER PASS AUTOMATICALLY

A signature or a Gift costs a charge each time you use it and does one of four things: a bigger trait die, another trait, the Monster rolled safely, or an approach of your own (the Draught changes form instead). Each still needs a roll (Chapter 3).

Castle Duties

Every Entity keeps one job at the castle and shops for one kind of item. **At a location whose list item is your Duty's kind, your trait die is one size larger on your own rolls there** (the furniture's obstacle included; not in a chase); it counts as that roll's one raise (Chapter 3). Each Entity's entry gives its default Duty; if two defaults clash in a party, the player who chose later picks another or rolls a d6, rerolling any Duty already taken.

D6	DUTY	SHOPS FOR	WHERE IN TOWN	AT THE CASTLE
1	Cook	food and drink	the baker, the butcher, the tavern cellar	Keeps the castle fed and knows every kitchen door
2	Gardener	plants and seeds	the market garden, the florist, the seed merchant	Knows what grows where, and what's poisonous
3	Librarian	books and paper	the bookseller, the printer, the schoolhouse	Reads the town's notices and signs
4	Butler	silver, china and linen	the silversmith, the china shop, the laundry	Knows how fine houses run, and where they keep the good spoons
5	Handyman	tools and hardware	the smithy, the ironmonger, the carpenter	Knows how locks and hinges work
6	Tailor	cloth and costumes	the draper, the tailor, the hatter	Keeps everyone's disguises in one piece

The Eight

The entries use terms from Chapters 3–6; a new player can take the defaults and come back to them.

Dracula



IN COSTUME



REVEALED

Brawn **d8** · Nimble **d10** · Sly **d6** · Charm **d12** · Wits **d4**

Signature: Mesmerise 1 CHARGE

At a watched obstacle that doesn't list Charm, roll Charm at 2 lower Difficulty. Only you get past, except at the way out and the lock-up (Chapter 3). Never in a chase. *He bends a mind with a look.*

Gift: Shape of the Night PICK ONE · 1 CHARGE A USE

- **Bat** (default): Roll Nimble instead of the trait the obstacle calls for (in a chase, instead of the ground's). *He flits up to the window.*
- **Mist**: Roll the Monster die without risking Suspicion: if it shows, Suspicion doesn't rise for it (Trouble or a Cost still counts). *If he shows, it's only fog.*

- **Wolf**: Your trait die is one size bigger for this roll (a d8 becomes a d10). *The strength and speed of a wolf.*

Perk PICK ONE · ALWAYS ON

- **Hypnotic Eyes** (default): On Charm rolls, the Monster shows only if it beats your trait die by 2 or more.
- **Old Money**: A Cost on a Charm roll is never Suspicion +1.
- **Wall-Crawler**: In a chase you can always roll Nimble, whatever the ground.

Castle Duty (default): Butler, who shops for silver, china and linen.

Weakness: Garlic. Always: from the first round of any chase, your trait die is one size smaller. *Every kitchen in town has some, and the mob knows it.*

Tell: No Reflection. *A shop window shows everyone but him.*

Frankenstein's Creature



IN COSTUME



REVEALED

Brawn **d12** · Nimble **d8** · Sly **d6** · Charm **d4** · Wits **d10**

Signature: Brute Force 1 CHARGE

Roll Brawn instead of the trait the obstacle calls for (in a chase, instead of the ground's). *Stronger than any man, it breaks what others pick.*

Gift: Made, Not Born PICK ONE · 1 CHARGE A USE

- **Mountain Stride** (default): At an obstacle that doesn't list Nimble, roll Nimble at 2 lower Difficulty. Only you get past, except at the way out and the lock-up (Chapter 3). Never in a chase. *He bounds over walls the way he crossed the glaciers.*
- **Hovel Watcher**: Roll the Monster die without risking Suspicion: if it shows, Suspicion doesn't rise for it (Trouble or a Cost still counts). *He learned to watch unseen.*
- **Book-Learned**: Your trait die is one size bigger for this roll (a d8 becomes a d10). *He taught himself from books.*

Perk PICK ONE · ALWAYS ON

- **Strong Back** (default): You carry a Huge piece alone.
- **Tireless**: Carrying doesn't make your Nimble smaller.
- **Built to Last**: You slip free from the lock-up on a Success or a Cost.

Castle Duty (default): Handyman, who shops for tools and hardware.

Weakness: Fire. Soon: from the third round of any chase, your trait die is one size smaller. *Someone has to light the torches.*

Tell: Head and Shoulders. *He stands a head above the whole crowd, and no costume hides it.*

The Mummy



IN COSTUME



REVEALED

Brawn **d10** · Nimble **d4** · Sly **d6** · Charm **d8** · Wits **d12**

Signature: Ancient Lore 1 CHARGE

Roll Wits instead of the trait the obstacle calls for (in a chase, instead of the ground's). *It knew this trick three thousand years ago.*

Gift: Secrets of the Tomb PICK ONE · 1 CHARGE A USE

- **Royal Bearing** (default): At an obstacle that doesn't list Charm, roll Charm at 2 lower Difficulty. Only you get past, except at the way out and the lock-up (Chapter 3). Never in a chase. *They still bow to a pharaoh.*
- **Just a Costume**: Roll the Monster die without risking Suspicion: if it shows, Suspicion doesn't rise for it (Trouble or a Cost still counts). *On festival night, who'd believe a real one?*
- **Old Curse**: Your trait die is one size bigger for this roll (a d8 becomes a d10). *A muttered curse, and the lock gives.*

Perk PICK ONE · ALWAYS ON

- **Patience of Ages** (default): "Lose a Turn" is never your Cost.
- **Keeper of Treasures**: "Drop an item" is never your Cost.
- **Fear the Curse**: When you flee alone, the mob in your local chase is 1 easier. *Nobody wants to get too close.*

Castle Duty (default): Librarian, who shops for books and paper.

Weakness: A Loose Thread. Soon: from the third round of any chase, your trait die is one size smaller. *Once someone grabs a loose end, it all starts to unravel.*

Tell: Dust and Spice. *A trail of dust and a smell of old spices wherever it walks.*

The Werewolf



IN COSTUME



REVEALED

Brawn **d10** · Nimble **d12** · Sly **d6** · Charm **d4** · Wits **d8**

Signature: Good Dog 1 CHARGE

Roll the Monster die without risking Suspicion: if it shows, Suspicion doesn't rise for it (Trouble or a Cost still counts).
If the wolf shows, the crowd sees a very large dog.

Gift: The Wolf Within PICK ONE · 1 CHARGE A USE

- **Keen Nose** (default): Roll Wits instead of the trait the obstacle calls for (in a chase, instead of the ground's). *It smells the way in.*
- **Through the Hedge**: At an obstacle that doesn't list Brawn, roll Brawn at 2 lower Difficulty. Only you get past, except at the way out and the lock-up (Chapter 3). Never in a chase. *It goes straight through.*
- **Howl**: Your trait die is one size bigger for this roll (a d8 becomes a d10). *A howl that freezes the crowd for a moment.*

Perk PICK ONE · ALWAYS ON

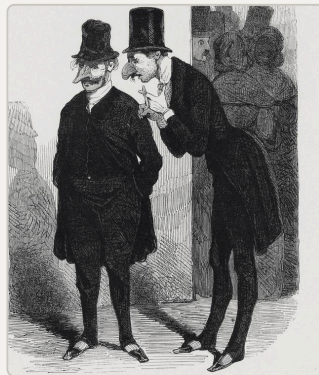
- **Night Runner** (default): When you flee alone, your local chase starts at Lead 2.
- **Shortcut**: The way out is 2 easier when you roll it.
- **Fetch**: The way out is 1 easier, whoever rolls it, while you're there, and a final flight you're in starts at Lead 3. *You know the way home.*

Castle Duty (default): Gardener, who shops for plants and seeds.

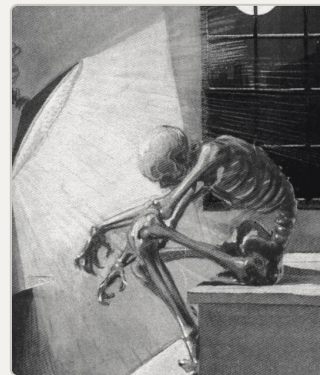
Weakness: Hounds. Soon: from the third round of any chase, your trait die is one size smaller. *Someone lets the hunting dogs out.*

Tell: Eyebrows That Meet. Brows that meet in the middle, and a little too much hair everywhere.

The Invisible Man



IN COSTUME



REVEALED

Brawn **d4** · Nimble **d8** · Sly **d12** · Charm **d6** · Wits **d10**

Signature: Unseen 1 CHARGE

Roll the Monster die without risking Suspicion: if it shows, Suspicion doesn't rise for it (Trouble or a Cost still counts).
When the Monster shows, there's nothing to see.

Gift: A Scientist's Tricks PICK ONE · 1 CHARGE A USE

- **Through the Gap** (default): At an obstacle that doesn't list Nimble, roll Nimble at 2 lower Difficulty. Only you get past, except at the way out and the lock-up (Chapter 3). Never in a chase. *He slips through as the door swings shut.*
- **Poltergeist**: Your trait die is one size bigger for this roll (a d8 becomes a d10). *Things move by themselves, and everyone looks the other way.*
- **Work It Out**: Roll Wits instead of the trait the obstacle calls for (in a chase, instead of the ground's). *A scientist's mind finds another way.*

Perk PICK ONE · ALWAYS ON

- **Out of Sight** (default): Trouble gets you caught only while you or anyone in the same place carries loot or furniture. *They can't see you, but they can see a floating candlestick.*
- **Hidden Pockets**: Captured, you keep the loot you carry (not furniture).
- **Light Step**: The loud way costs you no Suspicion.

Castle Duty (default): Tailor, who shops for cloth and costumes.

Weakness: Flour. Soon: from the third round of any chase, your trait die is one size smaller. *Someone throws a bag of flour, and there he is.*

Tell: Bandages and Goggles. A wrapped head, dark goggles, a false nose, and a sneeze from nowhere.

A Ghost



IN COSTUME



REVEALED

Brawn **d4** · Nimble **d12** · Sly **d10** · Charm **d8** · Wits **d6**

Signature: Through the Wall 1 CHARGE

At an obstacle that doesn't list Sly, roll Sly at 2 lower Difficulty. Only you get past, except at the way out and the lock-up (Chapter 3). Never in a chase. Not while you carry loot or furniture: nothing you carry passes through. *It drifts in where there's no door.*

Gift: Haunting PICK ONE · 1 CHARGE A USE

- **Chill** (default): Your trait die is one size bigger for this roll (a d8 becomes a d10). *A sudden cold, and fingers fumble.*
- **Whisper**: Roll Charm instead of the trait the obstacle calls for (in a chase, instead of the ground's). *A voice in the ear.*
- **Fade**: Roll the Monster die without risking Suspicion: if it shows, Suspicion doesn't rise for it (Trouble or a Cost still counts). *A trick of the light.*

Perk PICK ONE · ALWAYS ON

- **Spectral** (default): You get past group obstacles without rolling and without using your action, even in a Turn you move; not while you carry loot or furniture.
- **Rattle**: The Monster showing on your roll is Suspicion +1, not +2. *Nobody takes rattling chains seriously.*
- **Already Dead**: Cornered in a local chase, you're back where you were caught and lose your next Turn instead of being captured (if the Limit comes that round, you just join the final flight).

Castle Duty (default): Butler, who shops for silver, china and linen.

Weakness: Cold Iron. Always: from the first round of any chase, your trait die is one size smaller. *Horseshoes, railings, a poker from the fire: every street has some.*

Tell: Cold Spot. Candles gutter and breath fogs wherever it drifts.

A Witch



IN COSTUME



REVEALED

Brawn **d6** · Nimble **d4** · Sly **d10** · Charm **d8** · Wits **d12**

Signature: Hedge Spell 1 CHARGE

One trait die is one size bigger for one roll in the same place, yours or a friend's (in a local chase, only yours).

Gift: Witchcraft PICK ONE · 1 CHARGE A USE

- **Broomstick** (default): At an obstacle that doesn't list Nimble, roll Nimble at 2 lower Difficulty. Only you get past, except at the way out and the lock-up (Chapter 3). Never in a chase. *In over the rooftops, quiet as an owl.*
- **Black Cat**: Roll the Monster die without risking Suspicion: if it shows, Suspicion doesn't rise for it (Trouble or a Cost still counts). *Everyone blames the cat.*
- **A Potion for That**: Roll Wits instead of the trait the obstacle calls for (in a chase, instead of the ground's). *There's a potion for everything.*

Perk PICK ONE · ALWAYS ON

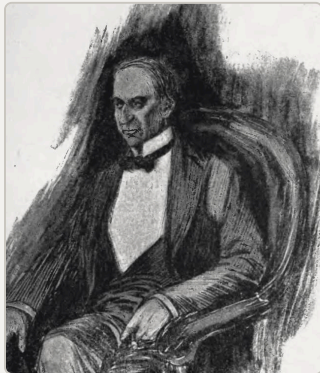
- **Familiar's Warning** (default): When you arrive (alone or with others), a Tell check goes off only if a second d6 also rolls 4–6. *The cat warns you.*
- **Fly by Night**: In a chase you can always roll Wits, whatever the ground.
- **Wise Woman**: A Cost on your Wits roll is never "lose a Turn".

Castle Duty (default): Cook, who shops for food and drink.

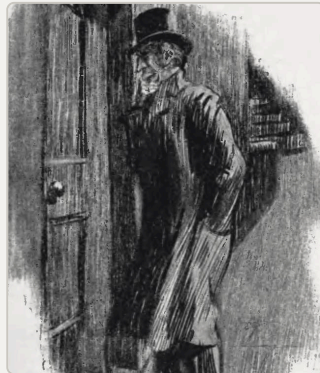
Weakness: Rowan. Soon: from the third round of any chase, your trait die is one size smaller. *A sprig of rowan, the old charm against witches: somebody's grandmother always has one.*

Tell: A Black Cat. A black cat follows her everywhere and stares at people.

Jekyll & Hyde



IN COSTUME



REVEALED

Jekyll: Brawn **d4** · Nimble **d6** · Sly **d8** · Charm **d12** · Wits **d10**

Hyde: Brawn **d12** · Nimble **d10** · Sly **d8** · Charm **d4** · Wits **d6**

Signature: The Draught 1 CHARGE

Before one of your rolls, change form: Jekyll to Hyde or back (each has its own dice). The new form lasts until the next draught. Each raid starts with Jekyll. When the Monster shows on one of Jekyll's rolls, Hyde takes over at once, free.

Gift: The Other Self PICK ONE · 1 CHARGE A USE

- **Doctor's Bag** (default): Your trait die is one size bigger for this roll (a d8 becomes a d10). *The right instrument for the job.*

- **Pillar of Society**: Roll the Monster die without risking Suspicion: if it shows, Suspicion doesn't rise for it (Trouble or a Cost still counts). *A respectable doctor having a funny turn (if the Monster shows, Hyde still takes over).*
- **Trample**: At an obstacle that doesn't list Brawn, roll Brawn at 2 lower Difficulty. Only you get past, except at the way out and the lock-up (Chapter 3). Never in a chase. A d4 as Jekyll, a d12 as Hyde.

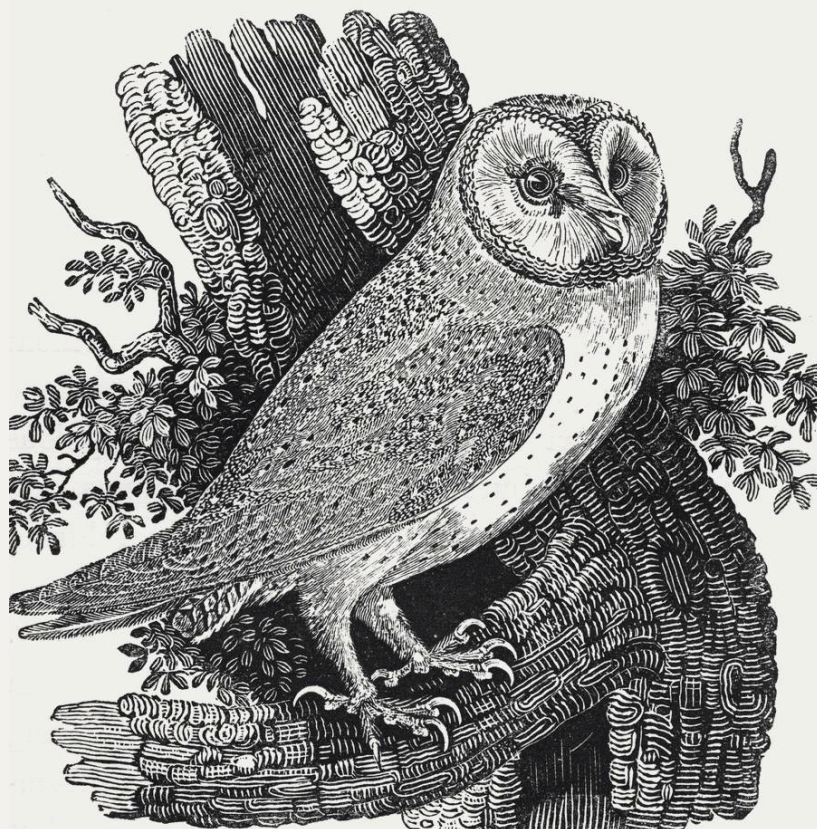
Perk PICK ONE · ALWAYS ON

- **Practised Hand** (default): Changing back to Jekyll costs no charge.
- **Steady Nerves**: Hyde takes over only if the Monster beats your trait die by 2 or more.
- **Brute Strength**: As Hyde, carrying doesn't make your Nimble smaller.

Castle Duty (default): Librarian, who shops for books and paper.

Weakness: A Familiar Face. Soon: from the third round of any chase, your trait die is one size smaller. *Someone in the mob recognises the good doctor.*

Tell: The Wrong Hand. *One hand a gentleman's, the other hairy and knotted.*





CHAPTER 3

Rolling the Dice

YOU ROLL ONLY TO GET PAST AN OBSTACLE (CHAPTER 4; the way out and the lock-up are obstacles too) and in each round of a chase (Chapter 6): your trait die plus your Mask or Monster die, added together.

The Roll

1. **The obstacle sets the trait.** Each obstacle (Chapter 4) lists the traits that work, usually one or two. When it lists two, one is usually marked as the **loud way**: rolling that one raises Suspicion by 1, whatever the result (Chapter 5). To roll any other trait you need an ability (below). In a chase, the ground sets the trait instead (Chapter 6).
2. **Choose the second die:** the Mask d6 or the Monster d10. (Carrying furniture, or in the final flight, it must be the Monster: Chapters 4 and 6.)
3. **Roll both, add them,** and compare the total with the Difficulty: **6** easy, **8** standard, **10** hard, **12** daunting.

Results

- **Success:** the total is equal to the Difficulty or more. You do it.
- **Cost:** 1–2 short. You do it, but the Storyteller picks one cost:
 - Suspicion +1.
 - Drop an item: one item of loot you carry, which the Storyteller picks. Never the loot this roll wins, and never furniture (dropping: Chapter 4).
 - Lose a Turn: you skip your next action (Chapter 4).
 - Your next roll's trait die is one size smaller.

The Storyteller never picks a cost that costs nothing right then. For example, Suspicion +1 costs nothing on a roll that already raises Suspicion, because one roll raises

it only once (Chapter 5).

- **Trouble:** 3 or more short. It doesn't happen, and Suspicion rises by 1. If the obstacle is watched (Chapter 4), you are also caught and must run: a local chase (Chapters 5 and 6).
- **Critical:** a Success where both dice show the same number. Outside a chase, you get back one charge you spent (never more than you started with). In a chase it counts as two Successes (Chapter 6).

In a chase, a result moves the Lead instead: a Cost costs nothing, and Trouble starts no new chase (Chapter 6).

The Monster Shows

If you rolled the Monster die and its number is **higher than your trait die's**, the Monster **shows: Suspicion +2**, whatever the result. A tie, or the Mask, shows nothing. *The monster did the work, and it showed.*

Abilities

Using an ability costs one charge. At zero charges you can still use one by **overdrawing**: it costs **Suspicion +2** instead of a charge. In the final flight it costs your Weakness instead: your trait die is one size smaller to the end of the flight (Chapter 6 says when you may).

Every ability but the Draught (Chapter 2) does one of four things:

- **Make your trait die one size bigger**, a **raise** (a d8 becomes a d10; a d12 can't go higher).
- **Use the ability's trait** instead of the one the obstacle calls for (in a chase, instead of the ground's: Chapter 6).
- **Roll the Monster die without risking Suspicion:** if the Monster shows, that adds no Suspicion. Everything else on the roll still counts: Trouble, the loud way, a Cost

picked as Suspicion, an overdraw.

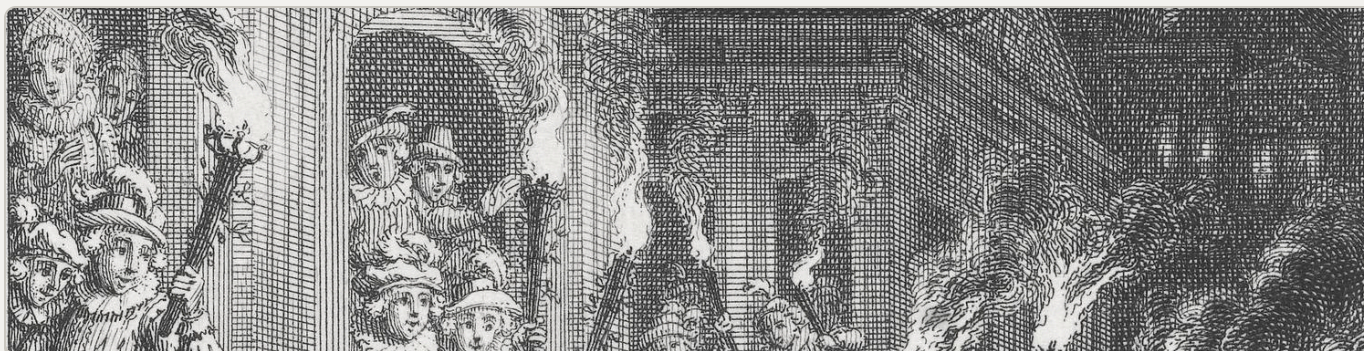
- **Open an approach of your own:** at an obstacle that doesn't list the ability's trait, roll that trait at a Difficulty 2 lower (a 10 becomes an 8). Never in a chase.
 - Any obstacle will do, not only a location's first one (its way in, Chapter 4).
 - The obstacle is still watched or not, as marked: Trouble at a watched one still gets you caught.
 - Only you get past it. It isn't beaten for the others: they must beat it themselves.
 - Two places work as usual. At the way out, your Success or Cost gets everyone out (Chapter 4). At the lock-up (Chapter 6), a rescuer's Success or Cost frees every captive, and a captive may open one to slip free.

Spend abilities before you roll.

- You can spend one on any Entity's roll at the same place as you (a location, the way out or the lock-up), even if you haven't got past the obstacles it has. In a local chase, only on your own roll (Chapter 6).
- Helping costs the charge, not your action.
- The roller always rolls its own dice: Brute Force spent on a friend's roll means the friend rolls its own Brawn.
- You can open an approach only on your own roll.

Several abilities may go on one roll, but only one of them may change the trait, and the roll takes **at most one raise**, from any source, Castle Duty included. A **step down** is anything that makes your trait die one size smaller: a Cost, your Weakness, carrying furniture (your Nimble only). Any number may apply. Net raises against steps down first: a d4 stepped down and raised stays a d4, and a d12 raised and stepped down stays a d12. Then apply the limits: nothing makes a die smaller than a d4, or bigger than a d12.





CHAPTER 4

The Raid

THE RAID HAPPENS ON THE TOWN'S YEARLY FESTIVAL, **Lantern Night**, when everyone dresses up as a monster — which is why real ones can almost pass in the crowd. Dawn ends it.

The Shopping List

Before the raid, the Storyteller rolls the shopping list (Chapter 8; Chapter 9's towns have theirs): **4 items on Easy, 5 on Standard and Hard** (how hard the town is: Chapter 1). One or two are **essentials** (one on Easy, one or two on Standard, two on Hard); the rest are **extras**. To win, bring home every essential, with at most one extra missing (Chapter 7). Each item is one of six kinds (the "Shops for" column of the Castle Duties table, Chapter 2); its kind decides whose Castle Duty gives an edge at its location.

The Town

Every town is built from the same parts:

- **An obstacle:** the traits that work (one may be the loud way, Chapter 3) and a Difficulty. It may be marked **watched** (Trouble there gets you caught, Chapter 5) and **group** (below).
- **A location:** 1–3 obstacles, which you get past in order, guarding one list item (sometimes two, when two items share a place). Whoever gets past the last obstacle has the item in hand, with no extra action.
- **Two ways in:** a location's first obstacle comes in two versions (say, front door or back window). The party picks one the first time anyone tries the location, and everyone uses only that one there for the rest of the raid.
- **A watched location:** one with a watched obstacle, on either way in (the furniture's doesn't count). It gets a Tell check (Chapter 5). Being caught depends only on the

obstacle you roll.

- **The way out** of town (below), always watched.
- **The lock-up**, where captives are held (Chapter 6), always watched.

A **place** is any of these: a location, the way out or the lock-up. An **item** is a thing on the shopping list; the items an Entity carries are its **loot**; the furniture or decor is a **piece** (below).

Turns

The night lasts **12 Turns**. The party starts at the edge of town, at the way out; entering the town needs no roll. Each Turn, every Entity takes one **action**:

- **Roll** at the next obstacle where it is.
- **Move** to any other place. A move takes one Turn (two when carrying furniture, below; a map may say otherwise).
- **Pick up** dropped items (below).
- **Wait**.

Entities act one at a time, in any order, and each result counts at once: an Entity who moves has arrived, and an obstacle one Entity beats is already beaten for the next to act. Several may try the same obstacle in one Turn; each try risks Trouble. The party may split up. *On Standard and Hard it usually should: there's rarely time to visit every place together.* **Dawn** comes when the 12th Turn ends: anyone still in town runs for it in the final flight (Chapter 6).

Once anyone beats an obstacle (a Success or a Cost), it stays beaten for the whole party, with two exceptions:

- A **group** obstacle (a crowd, a guard who checks everyone): each Entity who wants past rolls for itself.

- An obstacle someone got past with its own approach (Chapter 3): the others must still beat it.

If two or more Entities roll the same group obstacle in one Turn, they make one **group check** instead of acting one at a time: all declare their dice and abilities, then all roll at once. Each gets past on its own result. Suspicion rises only once for the whole check, by the biggest trigger among the rolls (Chapter 5).

Furniture

One piece of furniture or decor (Chapter 8) stands at one of the list's locations, behind one extra obstacle of its own, after the location's others. That obstacle's Difficulty is 2 higher than it would otherwise be (at most 12). Once that location's loot has been taken, whoever is past all its other obstacles may try for the piece. Bringing it home turns a Win into a **Grand Year** (Chapter 7).

Carrying

- A **Bulky** piece needs one carrier, a **Huge** piece two (Chapter 8 says which is which). A Huge piece can't go through an entrance a map marks small.
- While you carry a piece, you can't use the Mask, and your Nimble is one size smaller. Carrying loot doesn't do this.
- Carrying a piece, a move takes your action in two Turns in a row. After the first you're **between places**, at neither one. You arrive when you take your action in the second.
- Taking the piece, once you're past its obstacle, is free. Taking it back up after it's been set down is an action.
- From the Turn it's first taken, it raises Suspicion by 1 at the end of each Turn, even while set down. That stops when it's carried out of town, lost (the town takes it back when its carrier is captured, Chapter 6) or abandoned.
- You may **abandon** it at any time, free: it stays where it is, makes no more noise, and can't be taken again.

Loot. An Entity can carry any amount of loot, and can hand it to another Entity in the same place at any time, free (not once it's caught, until its chase ends, and never to a captive: Chapter 6).

Dropping and Picking Up

- You may drop your own loot, or a piece you carry, at any time, without using your action. Not once you're caught, until your chase ends (Chapter 6).
- It stays where you are: a location, the way out or the lock-up. Between places, it stays at the place you left; set down a piece there and you're back at that place too.
- Anyone at that place may pick up any number of dropped items, as their action for a Turn.

Getting Out

The way out is one watched obstacle: **Sly or Nimble, or Brawn the loud way**, at Difficulty 6 on Easy, 8 on Standard and 10 on Hard. The party leaves together. One Entity rolls for everyone, but only when every Entity who isn't captured is at the way out. A Success or a Cost gets everyone out; a Cost here costs nothing. On Trouble, Suspicion rises and the roller is caught (Chapter 6); try again next Turn. Anyone still captured is left behind (Chapter 7).



CHAPTER 5

Suspicion

THE WHOLE TOWN SHARES ONE **SUSPICION** TRACK, from 0 up to a **Limit**: 11 on Easy and Standard, 15 on Hard.

What Raises It

TRIGGER	SUSPICION	FROM A ROLL?
Trouble	+1	Yes
The Monster shows	+2	Yes
Taking the loud way	+1	Yes
A Cost chosen as Suspicion	+1	Yes
Overdraw	+2	Yes
A Tell goes off	+1	No
Furniture taken, each Turn (even set down)	+1	No

THE LOUD WAY

When an obstacle lists a loud way and you take it, Suspicion rises by 1, whatever the result. If an ability makes you roll the obstacle's loud trait (say, Brute Force where the loud way is Brawn), it's still loud. A trait the obstacle doesn't list is never loud.

ONE ROLL, ONE RISE

One roll raises Suspicion only once, by its biggest trigger (overdraw included): the loud way and the Monster showing on one roll make +2, not +3. Good results never lower it.

Tells

The first time anyone reaches a watched location (Chapter 4), the Storyteller makes a **Tell check**: roll a d6, and on **4–6** a Tell goes off. Each place is checked once a raid, for the whole party.

- The lock-up counts, but not a captive's arrival.
- The way out counts once anyone comes back to it.
- A watched furniture obstacle doesn't make its location watched.

The check is made once everyone moving there this Turn has arrived. If it goes off, pick one of the arrivals at random (number them and roll a die) and describe its Tell (Chapter 2). The only effect is **Suspicion +1**.

Getting Caught

Trouble at a watched obstacle gets the Entity caught, and a **local chase** starts (Chapter 6). Only the obstacle you rolled counts: Trouble at an unwatched one starts no chase, even in a watched location, but still raises Suspicion. Everyone with Trouble in one group check is caught and flees together.

At the Limit

When Suspicion reaches the Limit — or dawn comes with anyone still in town — **the hunt is on**: every Entity who isn't captured flees together in the **final flight** (Chapter 6). If the Limit comes during a local chase, that chase ends at once (even if a runner's own roll brought it there on purpose) and its runners join the flight, but anyone cornered in that same round is captured first and stays behind. From then on Suspicion stops. It never goes past the Limit; extra points are lost.



CHAPTER 6

Chases and Getting Forked

THERE ARE TWO KINDS OF CHASE. GET CAUGHT DURING the raid and you run from a crowd; botch the whole job and the entire town turns out with pitchforks.

The Lead

Every chase uses a **Lead** track. Each round you roll against the mob's Difficulty:

- **Success:** Lead +1 (a Critical: +2).
- **Cost:** no change.
- **Trouble:** Lead -1.

Reach the escape number and you are clear. Reach 0 and you are cornered. In a chase the roll moves the Lead: a Cost costs nothing more, and Trouble doesn't start another chase. In a local chase, Trouble and the Monster showing still raise Suspicion (one roll, one rise); when several flee together, it rises once a round, by the biggest trigger.

The Ground

Each round, roll a d6 on the chase table at the end of this chapter. The result says which traits work this round for everyone in the chase, and always includes one that isn't Nimble.

Your Weakness

Once the mob brings your Weakness, you roll your trait one size smaller for the rest of the chase. Each Weakness (Chapter 2) says when the mob brings it:

- **Always:** from the first round of any chase (Dracula, a Ghost).
- **Soon:** from the third round of any chase (everyone else).
- The final flight is a new chase, even for those who join it from a local one.

The Local Chase

When you are caught during the raid, you run, and you can't drop or hand over anything until the chase ends. Your Lead starts at **1** and you escape at **4**. The mob's Difficulty is **8 plus half the Suspicion** (round down), at most 12, checked each round. You may use the Mask. In a local chase, abilities help only your own roll. The chase happens within the Turn it started; escape and you're back where you were caught, with your Turn used up. Entities caught together in one group check flee together on one shared Lead, which moves by the majority rule below, and are captured together if cornered.

Captured

Cornered in a local chase, you are **captured**, and the town takes back what you were carrying, furniture included: it's gone for the night, and nobody can take it again. You are held at the town's **lock-up** (you can't pick up or be handed anything, but you can still spend charges, on your own roll or a rescuer's).

- **Rescue:** the lock-up is an obstacle — Sly, or Brawn the loud way, always watched — at the lock-up Difficulty (10), with a new rescue obstacle for each capture. Getting there is a move. Beat it (a Success or a Cost) and every captive there is free, at the lock-up, and acts again next Turn; a rescuer's Trouble gets them caught as usual.
- **Slipping free:** once per Turn, from the Turn after its capture, a captive may try to slip free: Sly or Nimble, or Brawn the loud way, at the lock-up Difficulty (it's always watched). Only a Success frees you; a Cost does nothing, and on Trouble Suspicion rises but no chase starts. A freed Entity starts at the lock-up and acts again next Turn.

- **Left behind:** anyone still held when the party leaves town is left behind (Chapter 7).

The Final Flight

At the Limit, or at dawn, every Entity who isn't captured flees together; anything dropped in the flight is left in town. The Lead starts at **2** and the party escapes at **5** (at **6** on Hard). The mob's Difficulty is set by the town's difficulty (10 on Easy, 11 on Standard and Hard) and doesn't change with the size of the party. Everyone flees together, so abilities can help anyone's roll.

THE MAJORITY RULE

Everyone rolls each round, in any order the party likes. If Successes outnumber Trouble, the Lead rises by 1, or by 2 if they outnumber it by two or more; if Trouble outnumbers Successes, it falls the same way; otherwise it stays. A Critical counts as two Successes.

Escape and you are home with the goods. Get cornered and the party is **forked**: the monsters in the flight are killed (a captive is left behind) and the raid is lost.

Once the Hunt Is On

From the moment the final flight begins, Suspicion stops and **the Mask is off**: everyone rolls the Monster die. You may still overdraw, once per flight, but your Weakness is then in play from your own next roll (even later the same round) to the end of the flight, and while your Weakness is in play, however it came, you can't overdraw.

The Chase Table

D6	THE GROUND	TRAITS THAT WORK
1	The crowded square. Lose yourself in the crowd, or bluff your way through.	Sly, Charm
2	Back alleys. Duck, dodge, double back.	Nimble, Sly
3	The market stalls. Overturn a cart, vault a stall.	Brawn, Nimble
4	Over the rooftops. Climb, jump, find a way down.	Nimble, Wits
5	The festival parade. Join in: you're in costume, after all.	Charm, Sly
6	A dead end. Break through, or think fast.	Brawn, Wits





CHAPTER 7

How the Year Went

WHEN THE PARTY IS OUT OF TOWN — OR THE MOB has the last word — look at what came home.

RESULT	WHEN
Grand Year	A Win, plus at least one piece of furniture or decor
Win	Every essential, and at most one extra missing
Partial	Less than a Win, with at least half the list home (missing an essential is at best a Partial)
Bust	Less than half the list home
Forked	Cornered in the final flight: the raid ends

Left Behind

Each Entity left behind in the lock-up drops the result one step: a Grand Year becomes a Win, a Win a Partial, a Partial a Bust. Bust is as low as it goes, short of being forked.

The Epilogue

The result decides the epilogue — how the castle’s year goes — and nothing else. Nothing carries over to the next raid, unless you play the optional campaign rules below. Read the line for the result, then (except after Forked) one line for each kind with an item on the list that didn’t come home.

RESULT	THE YEAR
Grand Year	A year of plenty. The new piece goes in the great hall, and everyone pretends it was always there.
Win	Full larders, warm fires. The castle creaks happily through another year.
Partial	The castle gets by, just. Someone has to sleep in the draughty tower.
Bust	A long, thin year, and a lot of arguing about whose fault it was.
Forked	The town tells the story for years. Next Lantern Night, the bells ring a little louder.

MISSING	WHAT THE CASTLE WENT WITHOUT
Food and drink	Turnip soup every night until spring.
Plants and seeds	Nothing grows but nettles, and the nettles win.
Books and paper	Nobody knows what the town is saying, or what day it is.
Silver, china and linen	Dinner is served on old coffin lids.
Tools and hardware	Every door in the castle creaks, sticks or falls off.
Cloth and costumes	Next year’s disguises are held together with string and hope.

OPTIONAL: CAMPAIGN PLAY

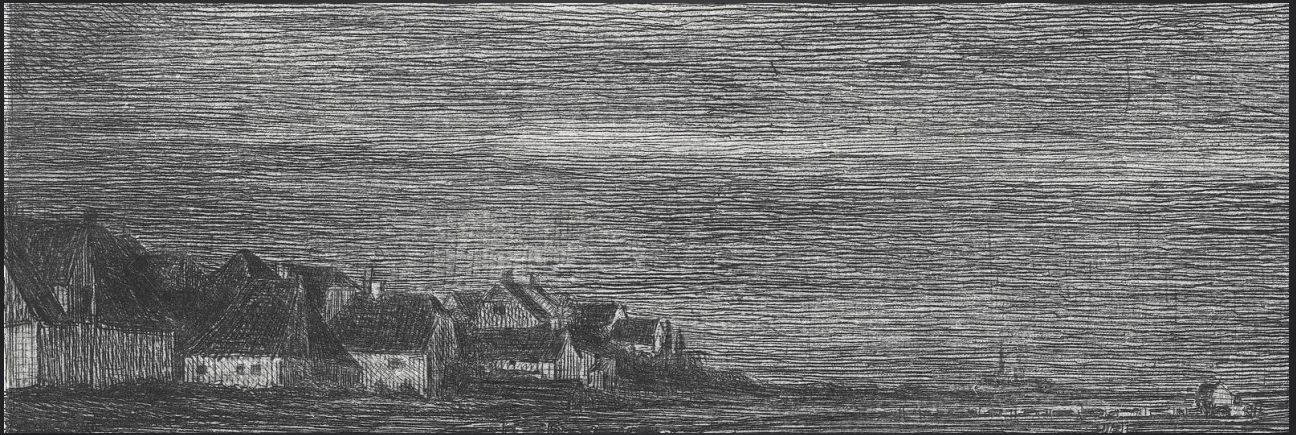
For groups who play several raids: each piece of furniture or decor brought home becomes a **castle upgrade**. In every later raid, each upgrade gives one Entity of the players' choice **one extra charge** (part of its starting number that raid). The castle holds **three upgrades** at most; bringing home a fourth replaces one of them. Nothing negative carries over, and the Entities themselves don't change.



PART TWO

Running the Game

*For the Storyteller: building a town, setting its difficulty,
and running the villagers and the mob.*





CHAPTER 8

Building a Town

EVERY RAID IS ON A NEW TOWN. THERE ARE THREE ways to build one, all from the same parts — obstacles, locations, and the way out.

Three Ways

- **A premade raid:** a fixed set of locations and obstacles, ready to run. Chapter 9 has three, one for each difficulty, each with its map.
- **A map:** a set of locations the party picks its route through.
- **The random tables:** roll the locations, obstacles, loot and villagers. A ceiling on the hardest obstacles keeps a rolled town playing at the difficulty it promises.

Lantern Night

On the festival night, everyone dresses up as a monster and carries a lantern to keep the real ones away. Every town keeps it its own way: roll a d6 or pick a custom for each town. Customs are flavour, not rules.

D6 LOCAL CUSTOM	
1	Turnip lanterns in every window.
2	A costume parade through the square at midnight.
3	A masked ball at the mayor's house.
4	Pies left on doorsteps "for the wanderers".
5	A bonfire in the square, and a straw monster burned at dawn.
6	Bells rung every hour to keep the real monsters away. They never work.

Rolling a Town

1. **Locations:** one for each item on the list, at one of the places its kind is found (the shopping table below lists them): a d3 or pick, one item per place; if a kind has more items than places, two may share a place (one location, guarding both).
2. **Obstacles:** roll a d20 for how many each location has.
3. **Each obstacle** (both versions of the first, its two ways in, and the furniture's extra one, 2 harder): the obstacle table for what it is, a d20 for its Difficulty, a d10 for whether it's watched. For the second way in, roll the obstacle table again until its quiet way is a different trait.
4. **The ceiling:** at most one Difficulty 12 in an Easy or Standard town, two in a Hard town (the furniture's obstacle counts by its roll, before its +2). Reroll any extra.

ROLL	EASY	STANDARD	HARD
Obstacles at a location (d20)	1–10: one · 11–18: two · 19–20: three	1–6: one · 7–15: two · 16–20: three	1–4: one · 5–13: two · 14–20: three
Difficulty (d20)	1–3: 6 · 4–13: 8 · 14–19: 10 · 20: 12	1–3: 6 · 4–13: 8 · 14–19: 10 · 20: 12	1–8: 8 · 9–17: 10 · 18–20: 12
Watched (d10)	1–4	1–5	1–6

The Obstacle Table

The quiet way gets past without a fuss; the loud way works too, but Suspicion rises by 1 whatever the result (Chapter 5). At a *group* obstacle, everyone there rolls for themselves (Chapter 4).

D20	OBSTACLE	QUIET WAY	LOUD WAY
1	A heavy cellar trapdoor	Brawn	—
2	A tug-of-war across the lane (<i>group</i>)	Brawn	—
3	A cart blocking the alley	Brawn	Nimble (scramble over the load)
4	A bolted back gate	Brawn (lift it off its hinges)	Charm (shout “Delivery!” until someone opens it)
5	A high garden wall	Nimble	Brawn (through the gate, lock and all)
6	A shuttered window	Nimble	Brawn (force the shutters)
7	The rooftops (<i>group</i>)	Nimble	—
8	A rickety drainpipe	Nimble	—
9	A locked front door	Sly (pick the lock)	Brawn (kick it in)
10	A nosy neighbour at her window	Sly	Wits (a false alarm: “Your cat’s on the roof!”)
11	A crowded shop floor (<i>group</i>)	Sly	—
12	A muddy yard full of geese	Sly	Nimble (run for it, honking)
13	The shopkeeper behind the counter	Charm	Sly (snatch it from under her nose)
14	A guard dog	Charm (good dog)	Nimble (outrun it, barking)
15	A doorman checking invitations	Charm	Wits (a forged invitation that fools nobody for long)
16	Children in costumes who want a closer look (<i>group</i>)	Charm	—
17	A locked strongbox	Wits (work out the catch)	Charm (sweet-talk the clerk into opening it)
18	A dark, cluttered back room	Wits	Sly (rummage through everything)
19	The night watchman on his round	Wits (time his round)	—
20	A maze of festival stalls (<i>group</i>)	Wits	—

Difficulty

Choose Easy, Standard or Hard. The difficulty sets these numbers:

	EASY	STANDARD	HARD
Shopping list (essentials)	4 (1)	5 (1–2)	5 (2)
Obstacle Difficulties: share of 6 · 8 · 10 · 12	15 · 50 · 30 · 5%	15 · 50 · 30 · 5%	0 · 40 · 45 · 15%
Suspicion Limit	11	11	15
The final flight: escape at Lead	5	5	6
The way out: Difficulty	6	8	10
The final flight: mob Difficulty	10	11	11
The lock-up: Difficulty	10	10	10

On every difficulty: 3 charges per Entity, 12 Turns, overdraw +2 Suspicion; a local chase starts at Lead 1 and escapes at 4 against a mob of 8 plus half the Suspicion (at most 12); the final flight starts at Lead 2. In a rolled town no entrance is small.

The Shopping List

For each item, roll a d6 for its kind and a d6 for the item itself; roll again on a repeated item. The first items rolled are the essentials (how many: the difficulty table above; on Standard, roll any die: odd, one; even, two). Only the kind matters to the rules: it decides which Castle Duty gets its edge there.

D6	KIND	THE ITEM (SECOND D6)
1	Food and drink <i>the baker, the butcher, the tavern cellar</i>	1 a wheel of strong cheese · 2 a side of bacon · 3 a cask of red wine ("for the guests") · 4 a sack of flour · 5 a jar of honey · 6 the wedding cake in the shop window
2	Plants and seeds <i>the market garden, the florist, the seed merchant</i>	1 seed potatoes · 2 a pot of nightshade (purely ornamental) · 3 rose bushes for the graveyard · 4 turnip seed for next year's lanterns · 5 a crate of lilies · 6 mushroom spawn for the cellar
3	Books and paper <i>the bookseller, the printer, the schoolhouse</i>	1 this week's newspapers · 2 black-edged writing paper · 3 a cookbook "for the guests" · 4 ink and sealing wax · 5 an almanac with next year's moons · 6 a book of etiquette
4	Silver, china and linen <i>the silversmith, the china shop, the laundry</i>	1 the silver spoons · 2 a tea service · 3 bed linen · 4 a lace tablecloth · 5 a pair of candlesticks · 6 a gravy boat
5	Tools and hardware <i>the smithy, the ironmonger, the carpenter</i>	1 a box of nails · 2 a new lock for the dungeon · 3 hinges that creak properly · 4 a lamp and a can of oil · 5 a coil of rope · 6 a length of good chain
6	Cloth and costumes <i>the draper, the tailor, the hatter</i>	1 a bolt of black velvet · 2 bandages, lots · 3 a top hat · 4 a new cape · 5 knitting wool · 6 boots in a very large size

OBSTACLES

Give each obstacle one or two traits that work. When there are two, usually one is the loud way. Mark which obstacles are watched — Trouble there gets an Entity caught — and which are group obstacles that each Entity must roll for itself. Give each location two versions of its first obstacle, with different traits: its two ways in.

The Furniture

Roll a d6 for the piece of furniture or decor standing at one of the list's locations (pick, or number them and roll a d6, rerolling a number without one; Chapter 4).

D6	THE PIECE	SIZE
1	A wingback armchair	Bulky
2	A gilt mirror	Bulky
3	A suit of armour	Bulky
4	A stuffed bear	Bulky
5	A grandfather clock	Huge
6	A four-poster bed	Huge

The Villagers

Whenever a watched obstacle needs a face, or a Cost needs someone to cause it, roll who it is and what they're doing.

D6	WHO	WHAT THEY'RE DOING
1	The baker's wife	Looking for a lost cat
2	The night watchman	Tipsy from the cider
3	A gang of children	Judging the costume contest
4	The vicar	Carrying a lantern and a pitchfork "for the parade"
5	The mayor, in his best costume	Gossiping, loudly
6	Old Granny Mott, who has seen it all before	Practising the bells

Running the Villagers and the Mob

Villagers and witnesses. Everyone in town is in costume and in a good mood, and they see what they expect to see. A watched obstacle means someone is looking; if it isn't already a person, give them a face (one of a ready-made town's villagers, or a roll). Play the town busy and cheerful, until it isn't.

Choosing Costs. Pick the one that hurts most right now, but never one that costs nothing (Chapter 3). A lost Turn bites near dawn, a smaller die before a hard roll, “drop an item” when someone carries loot, Suspicion +1 near the Limit. A Cost at the way out costs nothing: everyone still leaves. Always say what happened: the baker’s wife looks twice.

Suspicion. Keep the track where everyone can see it, and let the town’s mood follow it: whispers, then pointing, then torches.

The mob. Once the hunt is on, the mob is like the weather: always there, always closer. Read the ground off the chase table every round. When a Weakness comes into play

(Chapter 6), make it a moment.

The lock-up. Capture is a setback, not an ending. The captive can try to slip free every Turn, and the others can come for them (Chapter 6). Keep the captive’s player, and anyone else waiting, busy: let them voice a jailer or a villager.

Pacing. Count the Turns aloud, and warn when three are left. Early on, give each player a job that suits their monster, and a new player a Difficulty 8 first. A Bulky piece by the way out still costs at least 2 Suspicion to get home (a carried move takes two Turns). A raid should fit in an hour or two; roll a town before the session (it takes about half an hour).





CHAPTER 9

Three Towns

T HREE TOWNS READY TO RAID, ONE FOR EACH difficulty, each with its list, locations, obstacles, furniture, Lantern Night custom, villagers (its faces), numbers and map.

A location's first two rows are its two ways in: the party picks one and keeps to it. The furniture's obstacle is already 2 harder. On the map, an eye marks a watched location, a star the furniture. Any move takes one Turn.

EASY **Puddlecombe** *A sleepy village that has never had a real monster.*

Lantern Night: Pies left on doorsteps “for the wanderers”.

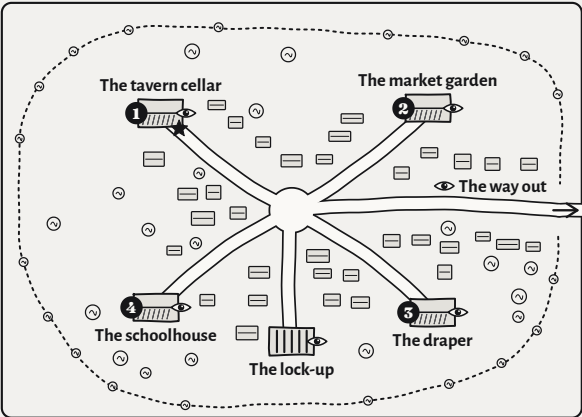
The shopping list (4 items):

1. **A wheel of strong cheese** (essential)
2. Seed potatoes
3. Knitting wool
4. An almanac with next year's moons

The furniture: a stuffed bear (Bulky), at the tavern cellar (1).

Villagers: the baker's wife (looking for a lost cat); the night watchman (tipsy from the cider).

Easy: Suspicion Limit 11 · the way out 6 · the lock-up 10 · the final flight: mob 10, escape at Lead 5.



LOCATION · OBSTACLE		QUIET WAY	LOUD WAY	DIFFICULTY
1 The tavern cellar: a wheel of strong cheese (food and drink) · essential				
WAY IN	A locked front door <i>watched</i>	Sly (pick the lock)	Brawn (kick it in)	8
OR	A heavy cellar trapdoor <i>watched</i>	Brawn	—	8
THEN	A dark, cluttered back room	Wits	Sly (rummage through everything)	6
FURNITURE	A guard dog	Charm (good dog)	Nimble (outrun it, barking)	10
2 The market garden: seed potatoes (plants and seeds)				
WAY IN	A high garden wall	Nimble	Brawn (through the gate, lock and all)	8
OR	A muddy yard full of geese	Sly	Nimble (run for it, honking)	6
THEN	The night watchman on his round <i>watched</i>	Wits (time his round)	—	8
3 The draper: knitting wool (cloth and costumes)				
WAY IN	The shopkeeper behind the counter <i>watched</i>	Charm	Sly (snatch it from under her nose)	8
OR	A shuttered window	Nimble	Brawn (force the shutters)	10
4 The schoolhouse: an almanac with next year's moons (books and paper)				
WAY IN	A bolted back gate	Brawn (lift it off its hinges)	Charm (shout “Delivery!” until someone opens it)	8
OR	A rickety drainpipe	Nimble	—	10
THEN	Children in costumes who want a closer look (group) <i>watched</i>	Charm	—	8

STANDARD **Thistlewick** *A market town proud of its festival.*

Lantern Night: A costume parade through the square at midnight.

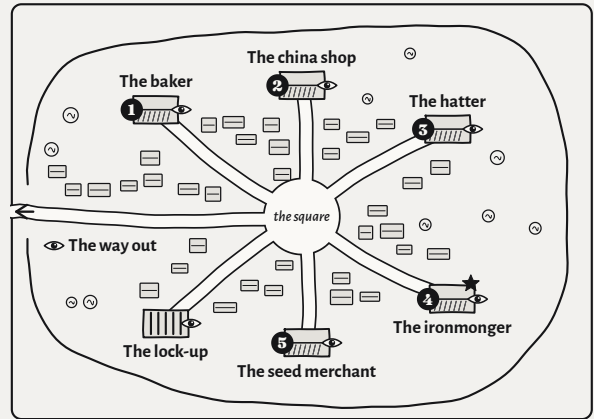
The shopping list (5 items):

1. **The wedding cake in the shop window** (essential)
2. **A tea service** (essential)
3. A top hat
4. A coil of rope
5. Turnip seed for next year's lanterns

The furniture: a gilt mirror (Bulky), at the ironmonger (4).

Villagers: the mayor, in his best costume (judging the costume contest); the vicar (carrying a lantern and a pitchfork "for the parade").

Standard: Suspicion Limit 11 · the way out 8 · the lock-up 10 · the final flight: mob 11, escape at Lead 5.



LOCATION · OBSTACLE	QUIET WAY	LOUD WAY	DIFFICULTY
1 The baker: the wedding cake in the shop window (food and drink) · essential			
WAY IN A crowded shop floor (group) <i>watched</i>	Sly	—	8
OR A shuttered window	Nimble	Brawn (force the shutters)	8
THEN The shopkeeper behind the counter <i>watched</i>	Charm	Sly (snatch it from under her nose)	8
2 The china shop: a tea service (silver, china and linen) · essential			
WAY IN A locked front door	Sly (pick the lock)	Brawn (kick it in)	8
OR A bolted back gate <i>watched</i>	Brawn (lift it off its hinges)	Charm (shout "Delivery!" until someone opens it)	10
THEN A dark, cluttered back room	Wits	Sly (rummage through everything)	8
3 The hatter: a top hat (cloth and costumes)			
WAY IN A nosy neighbour at her window <i>watched</i>	Sly	Wits (a false alarm: "Your cat's on the roof!")	8
OR The rooftops (group)	Nimble	—	10
4 The ironmonger: a coil of rope (tools and hardware)			
WAY IN A cart blocking the alley	Brawn	Nimble (scramble over the load)	6
OR A high garden wall	Nimble	Brawn (through the gate, lock and all)	8
THEN A locked strongbox <i>watched</i>	Wits (work out the catch)	Charm (sweet-talk the clerk into opening it)	8
FURNITURE A guard dog <i>watched</i>	Charm (good dog)	Nimble (outrun it, barking)	10
5 The seed merchant: turnip seed for next year's lanterns (plants and seeds)			
WAY IN A maze of festival stalls (group)	Wits	—	8
OR A muddy yard full of geese	Sly	Nimble (run for it, honking)	6
THEN The night watchman on his round <i>watched</i>	Wits (time his round)	—	10

An Example of Play

Four players raid Thistlewick: Dracula, the Witch, Frankenstein's Creature and the Werewolf, with their default picks (Butler, Cook, Handyman and Gardener). Suspicion starts at 0; the Limit is 11.

Turn 1. The party splits. The Witch and the Werewolf head for the baker, where the Witch's Cook Duty gives her an edge; Dracula and the Creature take the china shop, Dracula's as Butler. Both are watched, so the Storyteller makes a **Tell check** at each: a 2 and a 1, no Tells.

Turn 2. At the baker, the party takes the shuttered window. The Werewolf rolls Nimble d12 with the **Mask**: 10 + 4 = 14 against 8, a Success. The window is open for both of them

now, so the Witch goes on to the shopkeeper (Charm, 8, watched). Her Charm d8 is a d10 here (her Duty's raise), and she lets the **Monster** out for the bigger die: 1 + 4 = 5. That is 3 short, **Trouble**, and the Monster's 4 beat her trait die's 1, so it showed. One roll, one rise: Suspicion goes up by the bigger trigger, to 2. The shopkeeper was watching, so the Witch is caught.

She runs. Her **Lead** starts at 1, and the mob is 8 + half the Suspicion: 9. Round 1, a dead end: Wits d12 and the Monster, 12 + 3 = 15, Lead 2. Round 2, another dead end: 2 + 9 = 11, Lead 3, but the Monster showed: Suspicion 4, and the mob is now 10. Round 3, the festival parade, and out comes a sprig of rowan: her Weakness makes her Sly d10 a d8. She spends a charge on her Hedge Spell to raise it back and rolls

5 + 7 = 12: Lead 4, and she escapes. The Monster showed again: Suspicion 6. She is back at the baker, her Turn used up.

At the china shop, Dracula picks the lock of the front door with the Mask: Sly d6, a d8 with his Butler Duty, 7 + 2 = 9 against 8. The Creature takes the back room with Wits d10 and the Mask: 5 + 2 = 7, one short, a **Cost**. He has the tea service; the Storyteller picks the Cost. Dropping an item would cost nothing (he carries only what this roll won), so it's Suspicion +1: a teacup smashes. Suspicion 7.

Turn 3. The Witch tries the shopkeeper again, and the Werewolf spends a charge on Good Dog for her: she rolls the Monster without risking Suspicion. 7 + 4 = 11, a Success, and the wedding cake is hers. Dracula and the Creature move on to the ironmonger, which is watched: the Tell check is a 4, and a second roll picks the Creature, who stands a head above the crowd. Suspicion 8.

Three Turns gone, nine to go. Both essentials are in hand, but Suspicion is 8 of 11: from here on, every Monster counts.

HARD Gallowsmere *A walled town that remembers last year.*

Lantern Night: Bells rung every hour to keep the real monsters away. They never work.

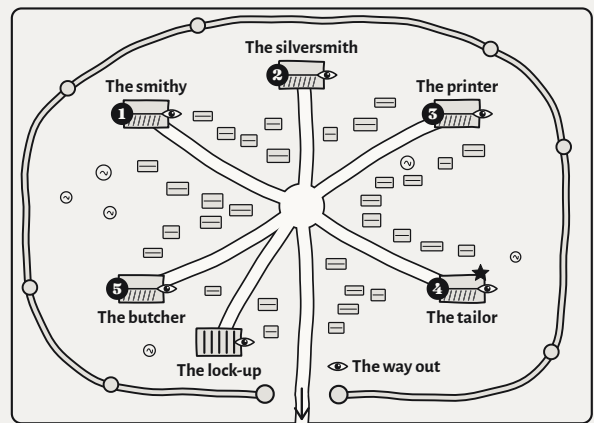
The shopping list (5 items):

1. **A new lock for the dungeon** (essential)
2. **The silver spoons** (essential)
3. Black-edged writing paper
4. Bandages, lots
5. A side of bacon

The furniture: a suit of armour (Bulky), at the tailor (4).

Villagers: old Granny Mott, who has seen it all before (practising the bells); a gang of children (gossiping, loudly).

Hard: Suspicion Limit 15 · the way out 10 · the lock-up 10 · the final flight: mob 11, escape at Lead 6.



LOCATION · OBSTACLE	QUIET WAY	LOUD WAY	DIFFICULTY
1 The smithy: a new lock for the dungeon (tools and hardware) · essential			
WAY IN A bolted back gate <i>watched</i>	Brawn (lift it off its hinges)	Charm (shout "Delivery!" until someone opens it)	10
OR A high garden wall <i>watched</i>	Nimble	Brawn (through the gate, lock and all)	8
THEN The night watchman on his round <i>watched</i>	Wits (time his round)	—	10
2 The silversmith: the silver spoons (silver, china and linen) · essential			
WAY IN A locked front door <i>watched</i>	Sly (pick the lock)	Brawn (kick it in)	10
OR A shuttered window <i>watched</i>	Nimble	Brawn (force the shutters)	8
THEN A guard dog <i>watched</i>	Charm (good dog)	Nimble (outrun it, barking)	8
THEN A locked strongbox	Wits (work out the catch)	Charm (sweet-talk the clerk into opening it)	10
3 The printer: black-edged writing paper (books and paper)			
WAY IN A nosy neighbour at her window <i>watched</i>	Sly	Wits (a false alarm: "Your cat's on the roof!")	8
OR The rooftops (group)	Nimble	—	10
THEN A dark, cluttered back room	Wits	Sly (rummage through everything)	8
4 The tailor: bandages, lots (cloth and costumes)			
WAY IN A doorman checking invitations <i>watched</i>	Charm	Wits (a forged invitation that fools nobody for long)	10
OR A rickety drainpipe	Nimble	—	8
THEN A crowded shop floor (group) <i>watched</i>	Sly	—	10
FURNITURE A heavy cellar trapdoor	Brawn	—	12
5 The butcher: a side of bacon (food and drink)			
WAY IN A muddy yard full of geese <i>watched</i>	Sly	Nimble (run for it, honking)	8
OR A cart blocking the alley <i>watched</i>	Brawn	Nimble (scramble over the load)	10
THEN The shopkeeper behind the counter <i>watched</i>	Charm	Sly (snatch it from under her nose)	10
THEN A tug-of-war across the lane (group)	Brawn	—	12

Entity Sheet

Copy this page for each player. Fill it in from your Entity's entry in Chapter 2.

Player _____ Entity _____

Castle Duty _____ Shops for _____

BRAWN	NIMBLE	SLY	CHARM	WITS

One each of d12, d10, d8, d6 and d4. The second die: the **Mask d6** or the **Monster d10** (it shows if it rolls higher than your trait die: Suspicion +2).

Charges ○ ○ ○ castle upgrades: ○ ○ ○ overdraw: Suspicion +2, or your Weakness once the hunt is on (once per flight)

Signature _____

Gift _____

Perk _____

Weakness _____ ☐ Always ☐ Soon

Tell _____

Form (Jekyll & Hyde; starts as Jekyll) ☐ Jekyll ☐ Hyde

CARRYING (LOOT)	FURNITURE	STATUS
		☐ In town ☐ Caught ☐ Captured ☐ Fleeing ☐ Out of town

Next ☐ roll: trait die one size smaller (a Cost) ☐ action: lost (lose a Turn, a Cost)

In a chase ☐ Weakness in play ☐ overdrawn this flight

Notes _____

One raise per roll, from any source. Nothing makes a die smaller than a d4.

At the Table

The rules on one page. The chapters have the details.

THE ROLL (CHAPTER 3)

Your **trait die** + the **Mask d6** or the **Monster d10**, against the Difficulty: **6** easy, **8** standard, **10** hard, **12** daunting.

- **Success:** meet it.
- **Cost:** 1–2 short. You do it; the Storyteller picks: Suspicion +1, drop an item, lose a Turn, or your next trait die one size smaller.
- **Trouble:** 3+ short. Suspicion +1; caught if watched.
- **Critical:** a Success on doubles. A spent charge back, or two Successes in a chase.
- **The Monster shows** if it beats your trait die: Suspicion +2.

ABILITIES (CHAPTER 3)

One charge each, spent before the roll. Raise your trait die one size; use the ability's trait; roll the Monster without risking Suspicion; or open your own approach with an unlisted trait (2 lower, your roll only, never in a chase). **One raise per roll.** At zero charges, overdraw: Suspicion +2, or your Weakness once the hunt is on (once per flight; from your own next roll).

TURNS (CHAPTER 4)

12 Turns, then dawn. Each Turn, each Entity rolls, moves, picks up or waits. A beaten obstacle stays beaten, unless it's a **group** one (everyone rolls). At a location with your Duty's kind of item: trait die one size larger (the one raise). Carrying: moves take two Turns. The way out: Sly or Nimble, or Brawn the loud way; one roll for all.

SUSPICION (CHAPTER 5)

Trouble +1 · the Monster shows +2 · the loud way +1 · a Cost chosen as Suspicion +1 · overdraw +2 · a Tell +1 (4–6 on a d6, first visit to a watched place) · furniture, each Turn once taken +1. **One roll, one rise**, by its biggest trigger. At the Limit, or at dawn, the whole town hunts.

CHASES (CHAPTER 6)

- **Local chase:** Lead 1, escape at 4, against 8 + half the Suspicion (at most 12); the Mask allowed, abilities on your own roll only. Cornered: captured (slip free on a Success, or be rescued).
- **Final flight:** everyone free; the Mask is off. Lead 2, escape at 5 (6 on Hard). Cornered: forked.
- Each round: roll the ground (the chase table); Success +1, Trouble –1. Together, the majority rule: 1 toward the side with more, 2 if it leads by 2+.
- Your Weakness: trait one size smaller (Always: round 1; Soon: round 3).

HOW THE YEAR WENT (CHAPTER 7)

Grand Year: a Win and a piece of furniture or decor. **Win:** every essential, at most one extra missing. **Partial:** at least half the list. **Bust:** less. Each Entity left behind: one step down.

	EASY	STANDARD	HARD
Shopping list (essentials)	4 (1)	5 (1–2)	5 (2)
Suspicion Limit	11	11	15
The way out	6	8	10
The final flight: mob · escape at	10 · 5	11 · 5	11 · 6
The lock-up	10	10	10

D6	THE GROUND (A CHASE, EACH ROUND)	TRAITS THAT WORK
1	The crowded square. Lose yourself in the crowd, or bluff your way through.	Sly, Charm
2	Back alleys. Duck, dodge, double back.	Nimble, Sly
3	The market stalls. Overturn a cart, vault a stall.	Brawn, Nimble
4	Over the rooftops. Climb, jump, find a way down.	Nimble, Wits
5	The festival parade. Join in: you're in costume, after all.	Charm, Sly
6	A dead end. Break through, or think fast.	Brawn, Wits

Once a year, the monsters go shopping.

Every year, on Lantern Night, the whole town dresses up as monsters. Every year, a few real ones walk in with them.

You play Dracula, Frankenstein's Creature, the Mummy, the Werewolf, the Invisible Man, a Ghost, a Witch or Jekyll & Hyde: housemates in a crumbling castle with a shopping list to fill before dawn. Hide behind the Mask, or let the Monster out and risk the town's Suspicion. Grab what the castle needs, and maybe a nice armchair. And if it all goes wrong, run, because the mob has pitchforks.



For 3–5 players and a Storyteller · 2–3 hours · ages 12+

DON'T GET FORKED · VERSION 0.1